

Activity Guide

How the HMF Design Clinic works

A hands-on team exercise. Your team acts as Cisco Solution Engineers for **Cedarline Health Group**. You read their situation, then work four use cases — for each customer pain point you take on, you answer with the right Cisco product and a short Solution-Engineer explanation of how it helps.

What you do, start to finish

- Form a team — pick a name and list your members.
- Read the customer scenario and the guidance in the Team Workbook.
- Work the four use cases: **1) AI Security, 2) Cloud Edge, 3) DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall, 4) Macro & Micro Segmentation**.
- Each use case lists the customer's pain points (**27 in total**). For each one you take on, write the **product / platform** and a **Solution-Engineer response** — how it addresses the concern and how it helps.
- Your proctor assigns which pain points to answer. Each use case is scored out of 100; four make **400**.

The four use cases

Use case	Pain points	What it's about
1 · AI Security	7	Protecting live AI apps and assets — runtime guardrails, compliance, supply chain, visibility.
2 · Cloud Edge	6	Consistent policy and containment across AWS, Azure, GCP and on-prem.
3 · DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall	5	Taming a complex firewall estate; encrypted visibility; unknown threats; fast response.
4 · Macro & Micro Segmentation	9	East-west control for the data centre and Kubernetes — workload and container level.

How to write a good answer

- Name a **product**, not a category (e.g. "Cisco AI Defense," not "an AI tool").

- Make the reasoning specific to Cedarline — their real constraints (no decrypting clinical traffic, ~10,000-rule segmentation failures, two firewall engineers, three cloud policy models, AI assets appearing faster than security can track).
- Say how it **helps** — the outcome for the customer, not just the feature.
- A product name with no reasoning scores low; reasoning true for any customer scores in the middle; reasoning that turns on something Cedarline said scores high.

REMEMBER Half the marks are the reasoning. The best answers sound like they could only have been written for Cedarline.